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WE THE FREE

TEAM FUNDINGRAISING GUIDE

CONTENTS



03
INTRODUCTION

04
WTF EQUIPMENT GRANTS

05
FUNDING PLATFORMS

09
GRANT APPLICATIONS

11
CROWD FUNDING TIPS

12
CONCLUSION



INTRODUCTION

Congratulations, you've made the first big step to apply for team funding. You likely have a number of questions as to how you should proceed, but first let's discuss what is likely the most pressing...

WHY FUNDRAISE YOURSELF?

1) There is funding available that can be acquired for grassroots teams, but is not available for international organizations such as We The Free. This way, **you are accessing funds we cannot!**

2) When We The Free provides funding for our teams, it will likely come with additional stipulations on how that money can be spent. When you are applying for the funding, **you get to more autonomy** on how to allocate those funds (subject to guidelines).

3) Fundraising is an essential skill, and investing now in learning this skill will help your community for years to come. It is also great for your own **personal development**!

4) By involving your team in fundraising, you have the opportunity to foster a culture of **independence, pride, ownership, and skill development**.

Now that we have clarified why applying for funding is a good idea, please read on to learn where you can find some sources of funding.



WTF EQUIPMENT GRANTS

We are committed to ensuring that WTF's limited funds are used fairly, responsibly, and in the most impactful way for animals. Because of this, it is not acceptable to allocate equipment or resources to teams that are inactive or unlikely to use them. To help us support teams effectively while protecting the long-term sustainability of our movement, the following guidance applies:

Starter Support for New Teams
All new teams—once they have successfully completed their induction—receive a WTF starter kit containing a few essential items to help them launch their activism.

Entry-Level Equipment Funding
Teams that actively build community have a much higher rate of long-term success. After a new team has:

- completed their first three community-building events, **and**
- scheduled at least their next three activism events,

they become eligible for an entry-level equipment grant, typically including 1–2 screens and signage.

Advanced Equipment Funding
Teams that demonstrate consistent activity, reliability, and strong engagement gain access to a higher tier of funding. This may include support for equipment such as:

- 4+ screen setups
- portable generators
- gazebos, roller banners, and tables
- other advanced or specialized materials

This tier is intended for teams that show clear commitment, strong team culture, and a track record of meaningful impact.

After reading the guide, submit your WTF application here. The rest of this guide relates to other fundraising sources that we recommend.

FUNDING PLATFORMS

For the sake of this guide, funding platforms will be separated into three sections: grants, crowdfunding, and traditional sources.

GRANTS

The Pollination Project is a vegan organization that provides $1,000 grants for grassroot organizations effecting change in a variety of fields, including animal rights activism. You can access their website here.

Thrive grants initiatives that eliminate industrial animal agriculture, create just, plant-based food systems, reduce animal consumption, and advocate for nutritious and/or local and sustainable vegan diets. Apply here.

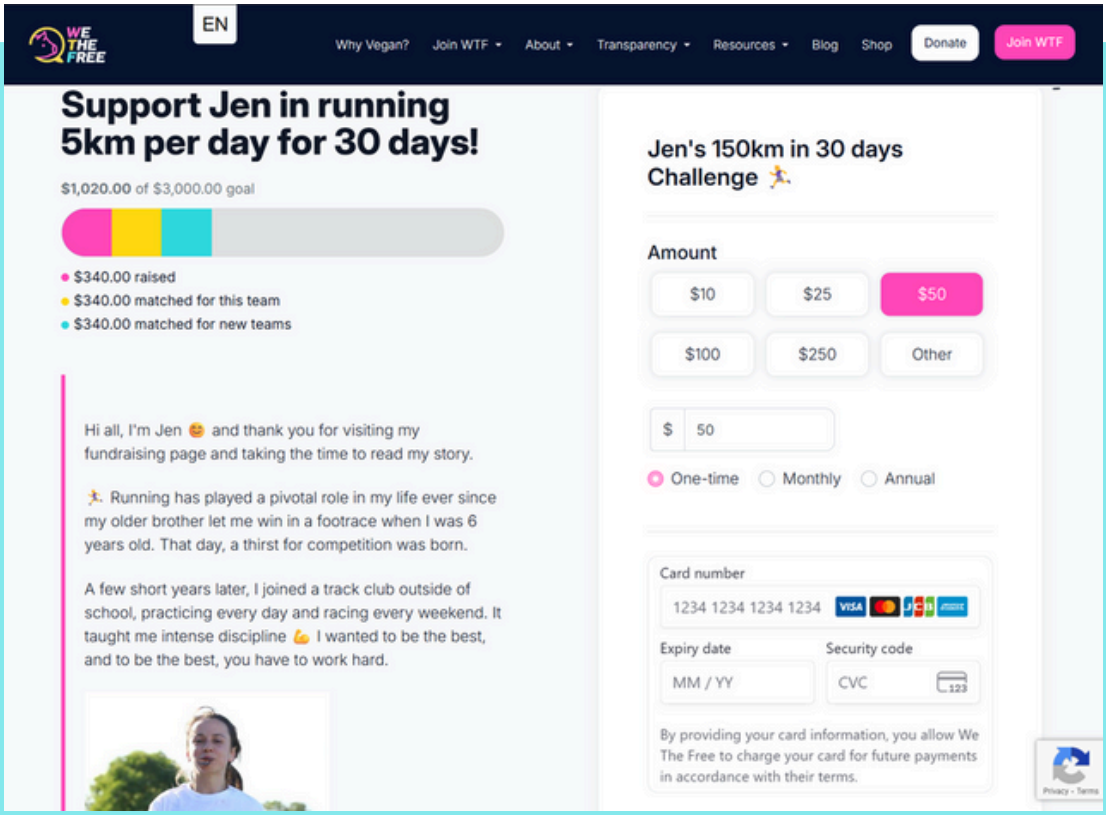
Similar to other organization , A Well-Fed World provides $1,000 grants to organizations who promote plant-based eating. They are not an abolitionist organization, instead choosing to focus on global hunger and climate change. You can access their website here.

The Vegan Society provides grants typically up to $1,700, with a focus on promoting veganism in unique, exciting, and positive ways. You can access their website here.

CROWDFUNDING

Crowdfunding is a method of raising money by collecting many small- or medium-sized donations from people who support your work. Unlike grants, crowdfunding can be launched at any time, promoted freely by your team, and adapted quickly based on your goals.

At We The Free, we offer teams the ability to launch crowdfunding pages directly on our own website, meaning you don't need to rely on platforms like GoFundMe or Patreon.



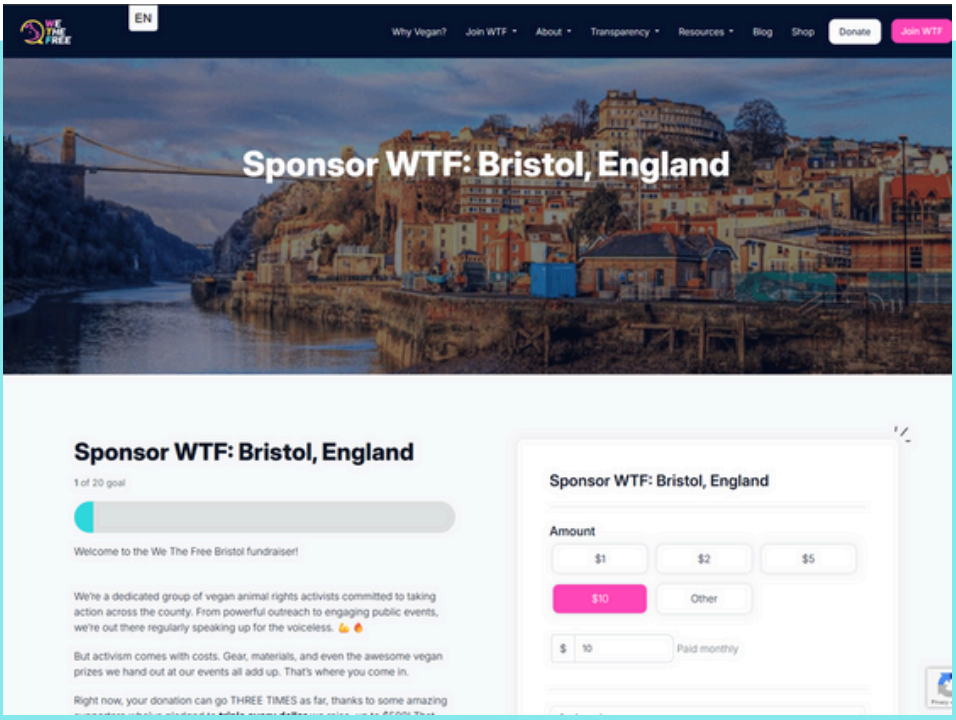
Traditional crowdfunding sites often charge more than 5% in platform and processing fees. By crowdfunding through the WTF website, fees are significantly lower, meaning more of every donation goes toward your activism.

Most external platforms do not provide donation matching.
When you crowdfund through us, your team gains access to our donation-matching partners — generous donors who match everything you raise, often **doubling or even tripling your impact**.

TYPES OF WTF CROWDFUNDERS AVAILABLE TO TEAMS

There are two different kinds of crowdfunding pages we can launch:

1. Sponsor a team (Recurring Monthly Support)
This type functions like a Patreon-style sponsorship. Supporters can choose to donate a small monthly amount (as little as $2/month) to your local team. These fundraisers help teams become increasingly self-sufficient over time.



2. Special Event & Goal-Based Crowdfunders
These are short-term campaigns for a specific purpose or event, often with a clear fundraising target.
Examples include:

- “Help us raise $1,000 to buy two portable generators.”
- “Sponsor our team as we complete a 24-hour outreach challenge!”

Want to launch your fundraiser on our website?

email our Fundraising lead James Pearce
campaigns@activism.wtf





TRADITIONAL FUNDING SOURCES



Including a donation box at your WTF Events is a good way to invite monetary gifts. Be sure to provide vegan donors with an opportunity to volunteer their time, as giving money can often lead to people feeling like they've already "done their part".



Tabling at a local vegan cafe or restaurant is an excellent way to gain exposure to the vegan community, have some great conversations about the need to be active, and solicit for donations.



Holding either an in-person or online auction is an easy way to engage the local community, promote vegan products, and invite vegan businesses to support animal rights activism in their area.



There are a variety of events you can organize to raise funds for your local team. From car washes to wine survivors, the options are nearly endless.

Important reminder:
Funds raised through WTF crowdfunders must never be used for personal expenses, salaries, stipends or payments to organizers.

WTF is a volunteer-driven movement. All spending must comply with the WTF Grant Agreement that will be signed before any funds are disbursed. A simple spreadsheet of expenditure + copies of receipts must be made available to sponsors for transparency.

GRANT APPLICATION WRITING

Most grant applications are straightforward and ask for precisely the information they seek. However, there are pitfalls that inexperienced applicants can neglect to notice if not careful. Please see below for some tips when filling out your grant application.



Provide Measurable Outcomes

It's one thing to say "we will have great conversations with the public about veganism" But a good rule of thumb is to express the results your team will achieve through data. As an example: *"Our team has a 30% conversion rate. With an average of 20 conversations per event, and a projected 120 events over the next 5 years, our data shows that 720 people will take demonstrable actions towards going vegan as a result of this funding."*

MyStats is a stellar resource for this. Don't be afraid to think outside the box, and share some results that don't immediately come to mind. These can include:

- How many volunteers has your team engaged?
- How many vegans has your team "activated"?
- How many people have attended your community building events?
- What total reach do your volunteers have on social media, collectively?
- What is the level of activism in your community? (IE: do you live in a small town where yours is the only animal activism events?)

If you need more data on your team's successes, email us for a more detailed report!

GRANT APPLICATION WRITING CONTINUED

Utilize Available Resources

Just because you are applying for your individual team, doesn't mean you can't take advantage of the plethora of resources WTF has to offer. These assets can include:

- WTF Website
- WTF Social Media Handles
- WTF Launch Video
- Volunteer Testimonials



Know How Funds Will Be Used

Most grant applications will request screenshots of the products you plan to purchase with the funding, at bare minimum. It helps to know what products or services you plan to purchase in advance. It is also worth mentioning that your team is a **volunteer run group with no operating expenses**, as this will make your application more appealing to the review board.

CROWDFUNDING TIPS

Crowdfunding has exploded over the past decade as a legitimate method to raise significant amounts of funding for causes both big and small. It requires a different skillset from grant writing, and may appeal more to the social media savvy among us. Below is a number of tips that can. be applies to running a successful crowdfunding campaign.

TIP #1 - TELL A STORY

The most powerful tool in your crowdfunding tool belt is your story. Stories resonate with people more than anything else. This can be a story about a particularly inspiring activist on your team, a meaningful sacrifice a volunteer has made, or an emotive story about seeing animals in a different light for the first time. You will know best because this is your story to tell!



A great example of exemplary storytelling would be the Edgar's Mission Chuffed.org campaign where they raised over $160,000 for a new sanctuary location. You can read their top tips here.

CROWDFUNDING TIPS CONTINUED

TIP #2 - SHARE EMOTIVE, HIGH QUALITY MEDIA



Use of high quality photos and video can elevate your story telling to the next level. They **provide a visual element** to **compliment your statistical impact**. This is another reason to be recording outreach conversations at Diamonds. as it provides us with media that can be leveraged to further our reach.

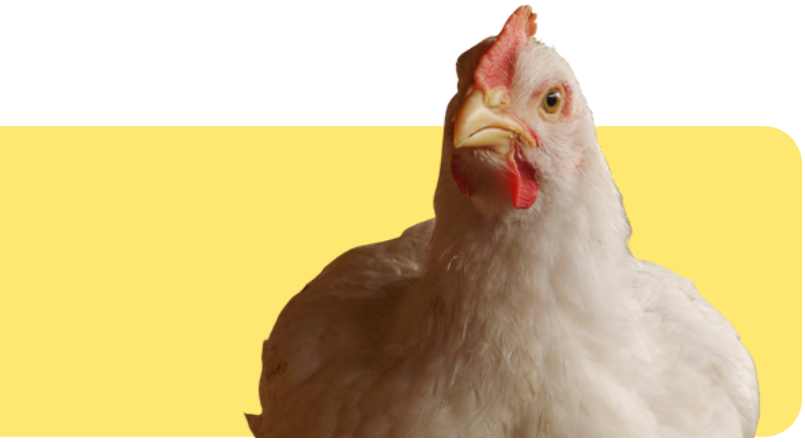
Media sharing should be **focused on the work your donors are supporting with their money**. This can include outreach conversations, sanctuary volunteer days, horror movie challenges, vegan food handouts, and all the other amazing work your team performs with We The Free. Ideally, you will share at least one photo from each type of event you facilitate.



CROWDFUNDING TIPS CONTINUED

TIP #3 - SET A REALISTIC GOAL

If your goal is too small, it might not seem exciting enough to be worthwhile of going through the donation process. If your goal is too large, it might seem insurmountable. There is a sweet spot for your campaign and you just need to find it.



TIP #4 - CREATE A UNIQUE & CATCHY CAMPAIGN TITLE

The best campaign titles accomplish a lot with the minimum number of words. According to GoFundMe, the best campaign titles accomplish these four things:

1. Capture the interest of the general public.
2. Describe who the fundraiser is for and why it's happening.
3. Convey a specific tone or emotion through your fundraising story.
4. Use keywords that make it easy to find.

TIP #5 - TEST YOUR CAMPAIGN

All of the aforementioned tips can be tested on your target market before launching the campaign. Does your story resonate with them? Is the campaign something that excites them? Does the goal seem realistic and worthwhile? These are questions that can be answered (and acted upon) before launching your campaign to ensure you have the greatest chance for success.

CONCLUSION

Animal activists are among the most passionate people on Earth. We sacrifice our time and energy, often on a daily basis, to advocate for those who most people don't even view as victims. Conversely, animal rights, particularly farmed animal rights, receives less than 0.1% of nonprofit funding. By taking these extra steps, we are helping to channel more funds where they are desperately needed, and leveraging the time dedicated to this important cause. Should you have any questions about the information provided in this document, please reach out to Hello@Activism.wtf. Thank you for your valuable work.

